

Lesson Well Learnt

It is certainly a pleasant surprise to see education penetrating the dark rooms of a jail ("No Shackles to Learning", July 9). Whether the inmates of the Bhopal Central Jail will get a remission or not, it would do the country a service if such a model was emulated by others.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

Revolution at a Low Cost

We have all seen what low-cost mobiles have done to India and it is only obvious that low-cost PCs can and will bring in another revolution ("The Race for the \$100 PC", July 9). For instance, net-banking and online reservation of railway tickets will surely bring to an end the long queues which are so typically Indian. And these are just two examples.

GIRISH TALUKDAR,
Thru, Assam

Plain Trivia

It is disappointing to see two pages being wasted on inconsequential problems of the FDCI ("Couture Clash", July 9). The fashion week is currently grappling with the decreasing number of buyers at the event. An event of this magnitude should attract many more buyers. Things like price rise seem trivial before this.

BOBBY AND MANJU GROVER,
Founder and ex-board members,
FDCI

King of Good Times

Rajnikant is India's Clint Eastwood ("The Boss", July 9). It would be better if he continues acting without throwing his hat in the

political ring. This is what legion fans of his want.

K. PRADEEP, Chennai

Sivaji: The Boss is nothing but a box office devil which has sucked the hard earned money of the poor. It had an empty bombastic style which won't do any good to society. The film was nothing but a PR exercise for Rajnikant. There was nothing extraordinary about it.

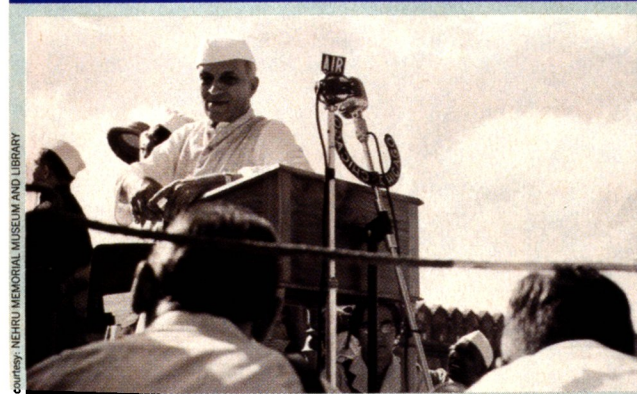
V.S. SANKARAN, Madurai

Grainy Problem

The major reason for the sorry state which the country's farming sector is in today is not only the lack of technological breakthrough but also the fact that the available technologies are not adequately carried forward to our farmers ("Grain Drain", June 11). But the apathy of the Government towards this is, indeed, disgusting.

S. KUMARASWAMY, Chairman,
Agrochemicals Policy Group

JOURNEY THROUGH TIME



"India at 60" was an enlightening journey through the contemporary history of our Independent nation ("60 Years of Independence", July 2). However, despite the country's growth and its urbanised and globalised exterior, the deep-rooted evils of dowry, female infanticide and riots over caste and religion are still rampant.

ANJANI KAPOOR, Chandigarh

This special issue is a great publication to pass on to the young generation as it is a short, succinct lesson in history. However, Shobhaa De's summation of the current era can easily be given a skip. It would be better if she goes through her largely incoherent piece again.

SUNIL MISTRY, London

It has been erroneously mentioned that K.M. Cariappa became the first Field Marshal of the Indian Army. The first Field Marshal was Sam Manekshaw.

BRIG S.C. SHARMA (RETD.), Mumbai

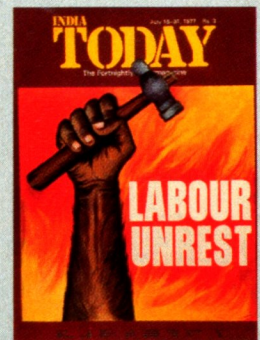
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30

Years Ago in India Today

JULY 16-30, 1977



Summer of Discontent

Discontent among workers is spreading fast in all parts of the country. Salaried staff are apparently as much affected as the so-called blue-collar labour, that is, workers on the shop floor. The latest to join the queue being the administrative staff of universities in Bombay and Calcutta—for the first time in 120 years as far as

Bombay University is concerned.



Striding workers
The dock and port workers have also threatened a countrywide strike unless their demands are conceded. Experts have estimated that unless something is done, and quickly, to douse the fires of unrest, the Janata Government may begin its very first year with a record 50 million man-days lost. The irony of the situation is that George Fernandes who led the railway strike three years ago, now saddled with the industry portfolio will find himself on the wrong side of the negotiating table for the first time.

—Jay Dubeshi